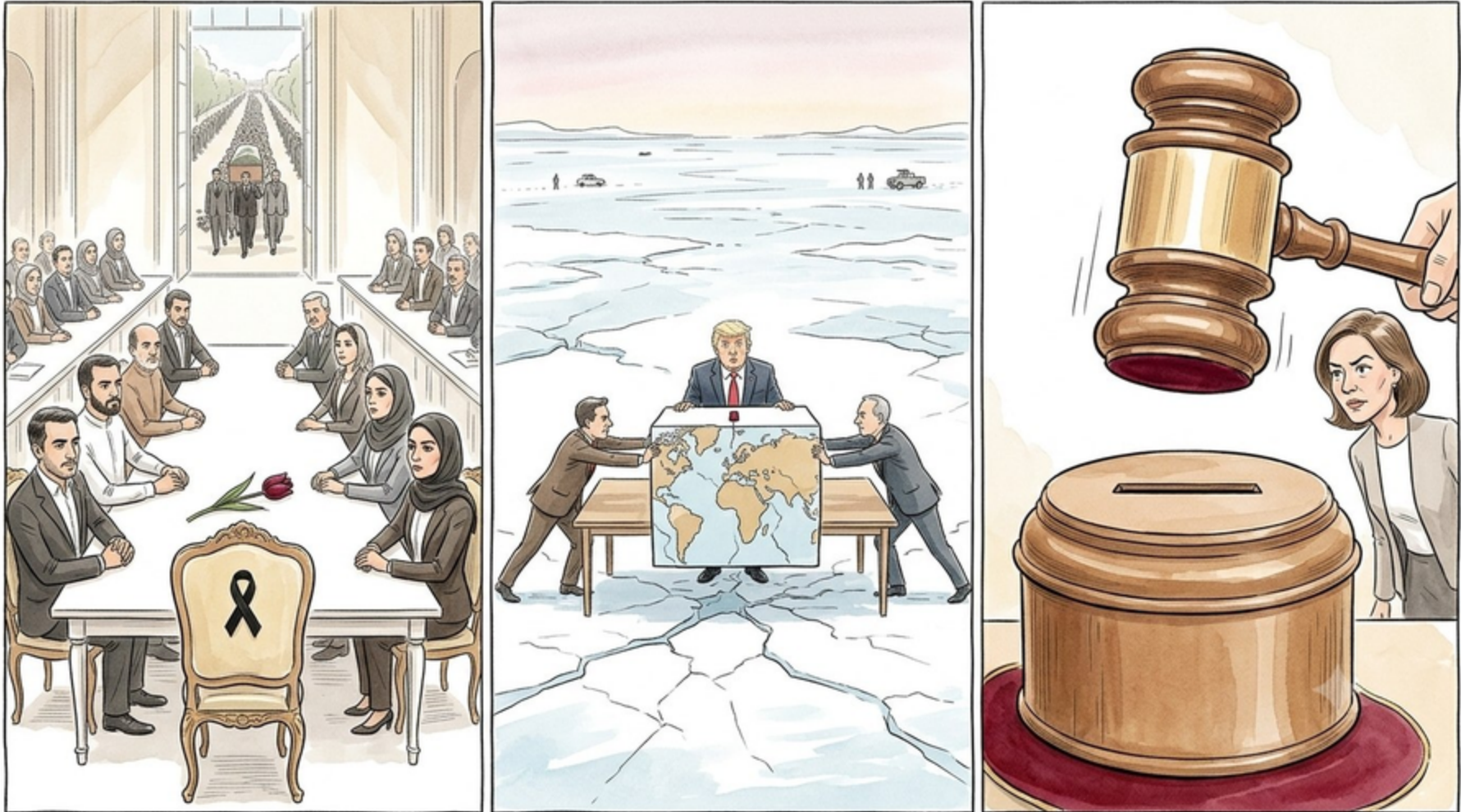


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Khamenei Laid to Rest as Iran's New Generation Flexes Power, Trump Pushes Peace on Two Fronts, Le Pen Awaits Verdict

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The Bottom Line

A week of funerals, summits, and verdicts. Iran laid Ali Khamenei to rest while his unseen successor Mojtaba's absence raised more questions than his presence would have answered. The new IRGC-linked generation running Tehran is more willing to fight and more willing to deal than the old guard — but the 'plastic moment' for a real regional reset depends on whether sanctions relief and reconstruction funding actually materialize. In Ukraine, Trump's twin calls to Putin and Zelenskyy ahead of the Ankara NATO summit signal a push for momentum, but the battlefield stalemate and Russia's unsustainable casualty rates mean neither side is negotiating from a position of obvious strength. France holds its breath for Tuesday's Le Pen verdict, which will determine whether the far-right's strongest candidate can stand in 2027. And Super Typhoon Bavi's devastation of US Pacific territories — the second such storm in three months — underscores the accelerating climate toll on military and civilian infrastructure alike.